

Project AQELYN Project Charter v2.0

Product Philosophy & User Experience Principles

Project	Project AQELYN
Document	Project Charter v2.0 - Product Philosophy & User Experience Principles
Status	Approved for Pre-Coding Baseline
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Language	English
Scope	Applies to all future Engineering Archives, implementation milestones, user interfaces, APIs, reports, dashboards, automated recommendations, AI explanations, and remediation workflows.

1. Purpose

This Charter update establishes mandatory product and user-experience principles for Project AQELYN.

Detecting security problems is not enough. The platform must make security understandable, explainable, evidence-based, and actionable for users ranging from home users to enterprise security professionals. To that end, this document defines the human-centered security model that every finding, recommendation, workflow, report, dashboard, and automated action is required to follow.

2. Mission Statement

Project AQELYN provides an intelligent Cyber Security Operating Environment that enables users of all experience levels to understand, evaluate, and improve their security posture through evidence-driven analysis, understandable explanations, and practical remediation guidance.

Clarity, trust, transparency, privacy, and usability take priority throughout the platform, without sacrificing technical depth or engineering quality.

3. Permanent Product Principle

Every finding must be understandable by a non-expert and actionable by an expert.

This principle is mandatory and applies across the full product lifecycle. A finding is not considered complete unless it explains what was found, why it matters, how it was determined, which evidence supports it, what should be done next, and what deeper technical details are available.

4. Product Philosophy Principles

Principle 1 - Explain Before You Recommend

A finding must clearly explain what happened, why it matters, how AQELYN reached its conclusion, and which evidence supports it. It must also describe the risks of taking no action, the remediation steps that are recommended, and the expected outcome once those steps are complete. Recommendations never appear without an accompanying explanation.

Principle 2 - Simplicity First

Security information is presented in language appropriate to the user's experience level. Complex technical terminology is introduced only when necessary and is always accompanied by a plain-language explanation. Understanding a security risk must never require prior knowledge of cybersecurity terminology.

Principle 3 - Evidence Before Opinion

Recommendations are never generated from assumptions alone. Each one references collected evidence, policy evaluation, engineering rules, threat intelligence, risk calculations, or deterministic analysis, and that evidence remains accessible to the user at all times.

Principle 4 - Human-Centered Security

The objective is to help people improve security, not to overwhelm them with technical information. Interactions should reduce uncertainty and increase confidence, encouraging secure behavior through education, understandable guidance, and actionable recommendations.

Principle 5 - Expert Depth on Demand

A simplified finding is a starting point, not a ceiling. Progressively deeper technical information remains available behind it, and the user interface supports multiple information levels without duplicating data.

Progressive Detail Model

Level	Name	Question it answers
1	Summary	What is the problem?
2	Explanation	Why does it matter?
3	Evidence	What data proves it?
4	Technical Detail	What exact configuration, event, object, or rule caused it?
5	Remediation	What should be done, manually or automatically?
6	Audit Trail	What changed and when?

Principle 6 - Transparency by Design

Users can always see what data has been collected, why it was collected, where it is processed, how long it is retained, and who can access it. Whether an analysis runs locally, is cloud-assisted, or is enterprise-managed is stated openly. Platform behavior should never come as a surprise.

Principle 7 - Privacy First

Privacy is a fundamental design constraint, not an optional feature. The platform supports local-only operation and offline analysis where practical, user-controlled telemetry, data minimization, explicit consent, encryption by default, and clear retention policies. Only the information required to perform the requested analysis is collected.

Principle 8 - Security Without Fear

Alarmist messaging has no place in the product. Rather than creating anxiety, the platform explains risks objectively, prioritizes findings, recommends achievable actions, and measures improvement over time.

Principle 9 - Progressive Guidance

Recommendations are prioritized in a fixed order: critical actions first, then high-value improvements, then best practices, and finally long-term optimization. Users should always know what to do next.

Principle 10 - Trust Through Engineering

Wherever possible, components are deterministic, evidence-driven, traceable, auditable, reproducible, and explainable. Trust is earned through engineering quality rather than marketing claims.

5. Finding Communication Standard

User-facing findings follow a single standard structure.

Required Finding Fields

Field	Purpose	Required
Title	Plain-language summary	Yes
Severity	Risk level	Yes
What Happened	Direct explanation of the issue	Yes
Why It Matters	Security impact	Yes
Evidence	Supporting data and references	Yes
Affected Assets	Devices, identities, domains, applications, or services	Yes
Recommended Action	Clear next step	Yes
Fix Difficulty	Expected effort	Yes
Automation Eligibility	Whether AQELYN can safely fix it	Yes
Expert Details	Technical expansion	Yes
Audit Trail	History and decisions	Yes

6. Standard User Output Pattern

Findings are rendered using a consistent pattern:

Problem: What AQELYN found.
Risk: Why it matters.
Evidence: What proves it.
Fix: What should be done.
Impact: What changes after the fix.
Details: Expand for technical evidence.

7. Example Finding

Non-Preferred Output

Weak password detected.

AQELYN-Compliant Output

Problem
Your NAS administrator account is using a password that does not meet the security policy.

Why it matters
Administrative accounts can control files, backups, and system settings. If this account is compromised,

Evidence

- Password age: 1,247 days
- Required complexity not met
- Similar credential pattern observed in breach intelligence
- MFA is not enabled for this account

Recommended action
Change the password immediately and enable multi-factor authentication.

Fix difficulty
Low

AQELYN automation
Manual approval required before any account changes are made.

Expert details
Policy: SEC-AUTH-004
Identity object: id:nas-admin-001
Evidence record: ev-identity-auth-2391
Risk score impact: -18 points

8. User Experience Requirements

UX Requirement	Description
UX-001	Every finding shall have a non-technical summary.
UX-002	Every finding shall have an expert-detail expansion.
UX-003	Every recommendation shall identify expected effort.
UX-004	Every recommendation shall identify expected security benefit.

UX Requirement	Description
UX-005	Every automated remediation shall require clear user consent unless pre-approved by policy.
UX-006	Every finding shall be linked to evidence.
UX-007	Every user-facing explanation shall avoid unnecessary fear-based language.
UX-008	The platform shall support home, SMB, enterprise, and expert communication modes.
UX-009	Users shall always be able to understand what data AQELYN used to reach a conclusion.
UX-010	Users shall always know what to do next.

9. Engineering Impact

These principles are mandatory architectural requirements. They apply to all Engineering Archives, implementation specifications, and coding milestones, and to every user interface, API, report, dashboard, AI-generated explanation, automated recommendation, and documentation set, including future product modules.

In practice this means that any engine producing a finding implements the Finding Communication Standard, any engine producing remediation guidance implements the Evidence Before Opinion principle, and any user-facing workflow implements both Simplicity First and Expert Depth on Demand.

10. Acceptance Criteria

This Charter update is accepted when the principles are included in the Project Charter and referenced by future Engineering Archives, the Finding Communication Standard is included in the implementation guidelines, and the UX requirements are part of the implementation readiness baseline. Future coding milestones must treat findings and recommendations as structured objects rather than plain text, and every future UI design must support progressive disclosure from simple explanation to technical evidence.

11. Implementation Guidance for Codex

When implementing Project AQELYN, Codex should treat findings as structured, typed objects. The implementation should include a canonical Finding model with fields for summary, explanation, evidence, recommended actions, severity, confidence, technical details, and audit history.

Raw technical findings are never rendered directly to non-expert users. Instead, they are transformed into user-appropriate explanations using the communication mode selected for the user or organization.

12. Charter Amendment Status

This document is approved as a Project AQELYN Charter v2.0 amendment and is included in the pre-coding baseline.